

number you wish to work with, but unless you want to end up experimenting and testing almost all the time, this is highly inadvisable. A complete exposure consists of the perfect aperture, shutter speed and ISO setting. Since you can alter each individually, the possibilities for trying out new combinations are endless, so it'll probably be smarter and less confusing to keep certain settings like ISO under limits.

When choosing the ISO for a shoot, remember that it will also impact your aperture and shutter speed needed for a well-exposed shot. Say, you increased your ISO to 400 from 100. You'll notice that now you can shoot at higher shutter speeds or smaller apertures. Thus, picking a good ISO can be tricky. Important factors to consider here include how well the lighting is, is the subject moving or stationary, whether you'll be using a tripod, how much noise levels are acceptable to you and so on. Let's consider two basic extreme conditions - on one hand, a pretty low ISO will work for you with negligible grainy effect if you have a stationary, well-lit subject that you click with a tripod. Similarly, if it's dark and you're not using a tripod for a moving subject, it's advisable to increase the ISO so you can still expose the shot well even at faster shutter speeds. Of course, a tradeoff of this higher ISO value is increased noise in images.

Now that you know what different terms mean in photography jargon, you should go right ahead and experiment with your settings to practically gain some intuition on how images will look with different combinations of each. A popular reference and an interesting read for enthusiasts is the book *Understanding Exposure* by Bryan Peterson where he elaborates the "exposure triangle" and explains how you can play around with these three settings: aperture, shutter speed and ISO values to achieve that perfectly exposed shot. Each of these aspects of the triangle relate to light and the way it enters and interacts with the camera, and more importantly how the terms are correlated and can't be isolated



The exposure triangle

without affecting the other parameters. Good control over these settings will enable you to bring more character and vibrancy into otherwise flat and just acceptable shots. **d**